

MAAT

MOOR ASCENSION AND TRIUMPH

THE ORCHARD PODCAST

SERIES ONE

Community, Family & Economics of Loyalty

Four Episode Scripts



- Episode 1 — "Your Network Is Already Built"
- Episode 2 — "Paying Your Friends Like You Pay Your Rent"
- Episode 3 — "Family Is the First Line of Business"
- Episode 4 — "What School Will Never Teach Your Children"

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EPISODE 1

"Your Network Is Already Built"

Stop searching for strangers when your people are already there.

Runtime: ~12 minutes

Series: Community, Family & Economics of Loyalty · The Orchard · MAAT

[Build with your people. Activate what's already there.](#)

INTRO

Peace, love, and light. Welcome to The Orchard.

I'm Sid Washington — founder of MAAT, Moor Ascension and Triumph — and today we're going to talk about something that almost nobody talks about honestly.

Not because it's complicated. Because it's uncomfortable.

We're talking about the people already in your life. And why most of us are walking past a fortune every single day without recognizing it.

Let's go.

SEGMENT 1 — THE SETUP

I want you to think about the last time you tried to grow your business, your brand, or your income.

Where did you look?

You probably thought about Instagram. TikTok. A cold outreach campaign. Ads. Reaching new people. Building an audience of strangers.

And I'm not saying those things don't work. They do.

But I want to ask you something first.

Before you went searching for strangers — did you talk to your cousin? Your old college roommate? The person who's been in your phone for eight years? The woman from your neighborhood who always asks what you're working on?

Did you talk to them?

Most people didn't. Most people walked right past the people who already know them, already trust them, already want to see them win — and went looking for strangers to convince.

That's not a strategy. That's anxiety dressed up as hustle.

SEGMENT 2 — THE DIAGNOSIS

Here's what I think is happening.

We've been taught — subtly, consistently — to separate our personal relationships from our economic life. Money is money. People are people. Don't mix them.

And that teaching sounds polite. It sounds respectful. Like you're protecting your relationships.

But what it actually does is keep you broke.

Because every successful economy in history — every one — was built on trust networks. On relationships. On community. On people who already knew each other doing business together.

The Italian community in New York. The Jewish community in the diamond district. Chinatown. Greenwood, Oklahoma — Black Wall Street. These weren't accidents. These were people who understood something we've been conditioned to forget:

The people who already trust you are your first market.

Not your only market. Your first one.

The stranger on Instagram has to be convinced. The cousin who watched you grow up is already convinced. The only question is whether you've told him what you're building.

SEGMENT 3 — THE ARCHITECTURE

I call this the Activation Model. And it works like this.

Your network is not a list of contacts. It's an economy waiting to be activated.

Activation means three things.

First: Tell them what you do. Not vague. Not "I'm working on something." Tell them specifically what you build, who it's for, and what it costs. Most people in your phone don't know what you sell. That's not their fault. That's yours.

Second: Ask for the specific thing you need. Not "support me." That's too vague. Specific: I need three referrals. I need someone to review this. I need introductions to people who have this problem. Specific requests produce specific results.

Third: Create a reason to send people your way. Give your people the language to talk about you. If someone who loves you can't explain what you do to someone who doesn't know you — your message isn't clear enough yet. And that's on you, not them.

When those three things happen — you're not networking. You're activating an economy that was already there.

SEGMENT 4 — THE DEEPER TRUTH

Now let me say something a little heavier.

The reason most of us don't activate our existing network isn't just strategy. It's fear.

Fear that they'll say no. Fear that they'll think less of you for asking. Fear that if you mix money and relationship, the relationship breaks.

But here's what I've learned.

The relationship breaks when you're broke and bitter, not when you're honest and building. The people who love you don't want to watch you struggle. They want to participate in your success. They just need an invitation.

Give them the invitation.

Stop being a secret to the people who care about you most.

CLOSING

Your network is already built.

The question was never how to find people. The question was whether you were willing to activate the ones you already have.

Stop networking. Start activating.

I'm Sid Washington. This is The Orchard. If this hit you somewhere true, share it with someone in your network who needs to hear it.

And if you're ready to build the brand infrastructure that turns your people into a real economy — The Lab is waiting.

Peace, love, and light.

EPISODE 2

"Paying Your Friends Like You Pay Your Rent"

Intentional spending on your people is the foundation of community wealth.

Runtime: ~12 minutes

Series: Community, Family & Economics of Loyalty · The Orchard · MAAT

Build with your people. Activate what's already there.

INTRO

Peace, love, and light. Welcome to The Orchard.

I'm Sid Washington. And today's episode might make some of you uncomfortable.

Good. That means it's working.

We're talking about money and friendship. Specifically: why you should pay your friends the same way you pay your rent.

Stay with me.

SEGMENT 1 — THE PROVOCATION

Let me ask you a question.

When your rent is due — do you pay it?

Of course you do. Because you have an agreement. Because there are consequences if you don't. Because it's a non-negotiable part of how you operate your life.

Now let me ask you another question.

When your friend — the one who does hair — asks if you need a touch-up, do you call her?

Or do you go to the salon.

When your boy has a restaurant, do you eat there?

Or do you go to the chain.

When your cousin started a photography business, did you hire her for your last event?

Or did you find someone on Instagram.

And the reason — if you're being honest — is some version of: I didn't want it to be weird. I didn't want to mix friendship and money. I didn't want to put them in that position.

Let me tell you what you actually did.

You paid a stranger. With the money you earned in your community. And that money left your community and never came back.

SEGMENT 2 — THE ECONOMICS OF LOYALTY

The Black community in America spends over a trillion dollars a year.

One. Trillion. Dollars.

And a fraction of that — research estimates somewhere between two and four cents of every dollar — circulates within the community before it leaves.

Compare that to other ethnic communities where the same dollar circulates five, ten, fifteen, sometimes twenty times before it leaves.

That's not an accident. That's culture. That's a practice. That's a decision, made over and over, to spend inside the circle first.

Now I'm not making this about race. The principle applies everywhere. To any community. Any family. Any tribe. The question is: where does your money go first?

Does it go to the strangers who built systems to attract it? Or does it go to the people you love, who are trying to build something too?

SEGMENT 3 — WHAT PAYING YOUR FRIENDS ACTUALLY MEANS

Now let me be precise. Because this is not about obligation. It's not about paying bad work just because someone is your friend. That helps nobody.

Paying your friends like you pay your rent means three specific things.

One: Intentionality. You make a deliberate decision to spend inside your network before you look outside it. Not because it's cheaper. Because it's strategic. Because every dollar you spend with your people is a dollar that can come back to you.

Two: Professionalism. You treat your friends' work with the same respect you'd give a stranger's. You pay on time. You pay the full rate. You don't ask for the hookup unless they offer. When you undercut your friend's price, you're not being close. You're being disrespectful.

Three: Communication. You tell them what you need. You refer other people to them. You become an ambassador for their work the same way they'd be an ambassador for yours.

That's it. That's the whole system.

It's not complicated. It's just intentional.

SEGMENT 4 — THE COMPOUNDING EFFECT

Here's what happens when a community does this at scale.

Money circulates. It builds. It compounds.

Your friend the photographer gets consistent clients from people who know her. She can afford better equipment. She raises her rates. She hires an assistant. That assistant is probably someone else from the community.

Your cousin's restaurant gets consistent reservations. She can afford to expand. She hires kitchen staff. She becomes a neighborhood institution. She starts catering events. She starts teaching cooking classes.

This is not theory. This is exactly how every wealthy ethnic community in the world was built. Not through individual genius. Through collective, intentional spending.

You are either building that flywheel or you're feeding someone else's.

SEGMENT 5 — THE MINDSET SHIFT

The hardest part of this isn't the spending. It's the mindset.

We've been taught to think that loyalty spending is charity. That we're doing someone a favor. That we're paying a premium for the relationship instead of getting real value.

That thinking has to go.

Your friend with the skill is not a charity case. She is a business. She is building something. Your dollar is not a gift — it's an investment in an economy you live inside of.

And when you think about it that way — when you treat your people's businesses the way you treat your bills — everything shifts.

Because bills aren't optional. Bills are how you keep the lights on.

Your people's businesses should be the same.

CLOSING

Paying your friends like you pay your rent is not a lifestyle choice. It's an economic strategy.

It's how communities build wealth that doesn't evaporate in a generation.

It's how a culture becomes an economy.

Start this week. Identify five people in your network who have a skill or a business. Make a plan to spend money with them in the next thirty days. Tell them why. Watch what happens.

I'm Sid Washington. This is The Orchard.

Peace, love, and light.

EPISODE 3

"Family Is the First Line of Business"

Your household is not your first liability. It's your first institution. Treat it like one.

Runtime: ~12 minutes

Series: Community, Family & Economics of Loyalty · The Orchard · MAAT

Build with your people. Activate what's already there.

INTRO

Peace, love, and light. Welcome to The Orchard.

I'm Sid Washington, and today we're going to talk about family.

But not the way people usually talk about family. Not "family first" as a feeling. As an architecture.

Because there's a difference between loving your family and building with your family. And most of us — even the ones who love deeply — have never been taught the second part.

Let's build.

SEGMENT 1 — THE MISCONCEPTION

There is a widespread belief in this culture — especially among entrepreneurs and builders — that family and business don't mix.

You've heard it. Maybe you've said it.

Don't do business with family. It only causes problems. Keep them separate.

And I understand where that comes from. We've all seen it go wrong. Someone loans money to a cousin who doesn't pay it back. Someone brings a sibling into the business and they clash. Someone gives a relative a job and it creates resentment.

Those things happen. They're real.

But I want you to notice something.

The people giving you this advice — don't mix family and business — are the same people who are not building generational wealth.

Because here's the truth: you cannot build something that lasts seven generations with strangers. You can't. Trust that deep, loyalty that durable, commitment that long — that only comes from blood and covenant.

Every dynasty in history — financial, political, cultural — was built on family structure first. The Rockefellers. The Rothschilds. The Medicis. Ancient Kemetic governance. Moorish economic systems. Indigenous trade networks.

Family was not a problem to be managed. Family was the foundation.

SEGMENT 2 — THE FIRST BOARD OF DIRECTORS

I want to reframe how you see your household.

Your family is not your first liability. Your family is your first board of directors.

Think about what a board of directors does. They hold vision. They check your blind spots. They commit resources. They protect the institution. They carry the mission forward when you can't.

Now think about your family.

Your partner sees what you miss. Your children are the reason you stay disciplined when you want to quit. Your parents carry the memory of what was sacrificed before you arrived. Your siblings know the parts of you that the world doesn't see.

That's not a liability. That's the most powerful advisory board you will ever have.

The question is whether you've activated them in that role. Whether you've had the conversation. Whether your family knows what you're building, why you're building it, and what role they play in it.

Most families carry enormous talent, diverse skills, and deep mutual loyalty — and they never once organize it toward a shared economic goal.

That's not a family problem. That's a structure problem. And structure is something we can fix.

SEGMENT 3 — THE FAMILY INSTITUTION

What does it look like when a family operates as an institution?

It starts with a shared vision. Not a vague one. A specific answer to: what are we building together? What do we want to be true for this family in twenty years? In fifty?

Then it moves to roles. Not imposed — discovered. Who in your family has financial literacy? Who has relationships? Who has creative skill? Who has discipline? Who has the gift of speaking truth when nobody wants to hear it? Those are roles. Those are positions on the board.

Then it moves to agreements. How do we make decisions? How do we handle disagreement? How do we protect the institution when individuals have conflicts? These conversations feel uncomfortable before you have them. They feel essential after.

And then — and this is the part most people skip — it moves to legacy documents. What do we leave? Not just money. What knowledge, what values, what systems, what assets do we pass down with intention?

That's a family operating as an institution.

That's the first line of business.

SEGMENT 4 — TEACHING BY BUILDING

Here's something I want to say directly to the parents in this conversation.

Your children are watching everything you do with money. Everything. The conversations you have at the dinner table. The stress you carry when the bills are tight. The decisions you make when opportunity arrives. The way you treat your own work.

They are building a financial blueprint from your behavior. And they'll carry it for the rest of their lives — unless you interrupt it intentionally.

The most powerful thing you can do for your children is not save money for them. It's build in front of them. Let them see the process. Let them see the vision documents. Let them sit in on the conversations. Let them have a role — even a small one — in something the family is building together.

Because a child who watches their parents build an institution doesn't grow up to be an employee by default. They grow up understanding that institutions are built by people, and that their family has always been one of those people.

That is the inheritance that lasts longer than money.

CLOSING

Family is the first line of business.

Not because blood is magic. Because trust is the foundation of all lasting economic structures — and the deepest trust you will ever have access to already lives in your household.

Activate it.

Have the vision conversation. Discover the roles. Make the agreements. Build in front of your children.

Your family is not your first liability. It is your first institution. Treat it like one.

I'm Sid Washington. This is The Orchard.

Peace, love, and light.

EPISODE 4

"What School Will Never Teach Your Children"

The education system was not designed to produce owners. Teaching ownership is the most radical act of love.

Runtime: ~12 minutes

Series: Community, Family & Economics of Loyalty · The Orchard · MAAT

Build with your people. Activate what's already there.

INTRO

Peace, love, and light. Welcome to The Orchard.

I'm Sid Washington, and today's episode is for the parents. For the aunties and uncles. For anyone who has a child in their life that they love.

Because we need to have an honest conversation about what school is actually teaching your children — and the critical things it is not.

This is not anti-education. I want to be clear about that upfront.

This is about understanding what school was designed to do. And making sure that the things it wasn't designed to do — you're doing them at home.

Let's go.

SEGMENT 1 — WHAT SCHOOL WAS BUILT FOR

The modern school system in America was formalized in the late 1800s. If you study that history — and I encourage you to study it — you'll find that the people who designed it were very clear about what they were building.

They needed a workforce for the industrial economy. They needed people who could follow instructions, arrive on time, sit in rows, do repetitive tasks without complaint, and defer to authority.

That's not a conspiracy theory. That's documented history. They said it out loud.

And to be fair — that system has done certain things well. It produces literate people. It teaches some math, some science, some language. It socializes children to operate in structured environments.

But here's what it does not teach.

It does not teach ownership. It does not teach how to read a financial statement, how to build a business, how to negotiate a contract, how to acquire property, how compound interest works in your favor, how to build a brand, how to understand equity, how to leave something behind.

It does not teach your child that their name is a brand. That their knowledge is a product. That their culture is an asset. That their time is capital.

Those lessons — the ones that actually produce wealth — are not in the curriculum.

Because the curriculum was not built to produce owners. It was built to produce workers.

And there is nothing wrong with work. Work is honorable. But your child deserves to understand both sides of the transaction.

SEGMENT 2 — WHAT YOU HAVE TO TEACH AT HOME

So what does a parent teach that school won't?

I'll give you the Sacred Scroll framework. Four initiations. Four ages. Four lessons.

At twelve: Teach them that money listens. Money responds to behavior. Show them a savings account. Let them watch a dollar grow. Teach them that time is a multiplier — for growth or for decay. The lesson is simple: Money responds to how I treat it.

At sixteen: Teach them that credit is reputation made visible. That their financial name walks ahead of them into every room they will ever enter. Teach them what debt is — not as fear, but as a tool they need to understand before it understands them. The lesson: My financial name walks ahead of me.

At eighteen: Teach them law. Taxes. Insurance. Contracts. Not the mythology around these things — the plain, unglamorous reality of how they work. Show them what a lease is. What a W-2 is. What an LLC is and why someone would file one. The lesson: I am now accountable for my economic footprint.

At twenty-five: Teach them ownership. Land. Equity. Compounding. Trusts. Legacy documents. Show them what it means to design something that survives your physical presence. The lesson: I am designing what survives me.

These four lessons, taught at home, with consistency, will produce something that twelve years of school almost never does: a child who understands that they can be an owner.

SEGMENT 3 — TEACHING OWNERSHIP BEFORE OBEDIENCE

I want to say something specific about how we raise children in this culture.

We teach obedience first. Follow the rules. Listen to the teacher. Don't question authority. Do what you're told and you'll be rewarded.

And I understand the instinct. We want our children safe. We want them to survive in systems that can be hostile. We want them to be able to navigate a world that was not designed for them.

But when obedience is the first lesson — and ownership is never taught at all — you produce an adult who is very good at following and has no framework for leading.

Ownership does not require disobedience. I'm not telling you to raise a child who doesn't respect rules.

I'm telling you to raise a child who understands that rules are made by people. Systems are built by people. Institutions are built by people. And your child is a person who can build one too.

Teach them that their name is a brand — not a label someone else gets to define.

Teach them that their knowledge is a product — not just a credential to hand to an employer.

Teach them that their culture is an asset — not a liability to apologize for in professional spaces.

Teach them that their time is capital — the only non-renewable resource they will ever have.

Those are lessons that will never appear on a standardized test. Which means if you don't teach them, they won't be learned.

SEGMENT 4 — THE RITE OF PASSAGE

Here's the practical piece.

Create a family rite of passage around financial literacy. Not a one-time conversation. A practice. An ongoing curriculum that lives inside your household.

At twelve, open an account with them and let them manage it. Not you managing it for them — them managing it with you watching.

At sixteen, let them see the household budget. Not every detail, but the structure. How much comes in. How much goes out. What the categories are. Let them understand that a household is a small economy.

At eighteen, sit with them and explain your taxes. Walk them through what an LLC filing looks like. Show them what insurance actually covers. Take the mystery out of the financial system by showing them how it actually works.

At twenty-five, if they're ready, bring them into whatever you're building. Give them a real role. Let them carry real responsibility. Let them feel the weight of ownership — because that weight is also what creates permanence.

This is not a perfect system. It doesn't require perfect parents. It requires intentional ones.

CLOSING

School will teach your children many things. And those things matter.

But school will not teach your child that they can own something. That they can build something. That their name, their knowledge, their culture, and their time are all forms of capital.

That lesson is yours to give.

It doesn't take money. It takes intention. It takes conversation. It takes being willing to build in front of your children so they understand that building is possible.

The most radical act of love you can offer a child in this economy is not paying for their education.

It's teaching them the things their education will never cover.

I'm Sid Washington. This is The Orchard.

Peace, love, and light.

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SERIES ONE COMPLETE

Community, Family & Economics of Loyalty

EPISODE 1 *"Your Network Is Already Built"*

Stop searching for strangers. Your people are your first market. Activate them.

EPISODE 2 *"Paying Your Friends Like You Pay Your Rent"*

Intentional spending inside your community is how cultures become economies.

EPISODE 3 *"Family Is the First Line of Business"*

Your household is your first institution, not your first liability.

EPISODE 4 *"What School Will Never Teach Your Children"*

School was built to produce workers. Your job is to teach ownership.

"Build with your people. Activate what's already there."

— Sid Morrison Washington

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